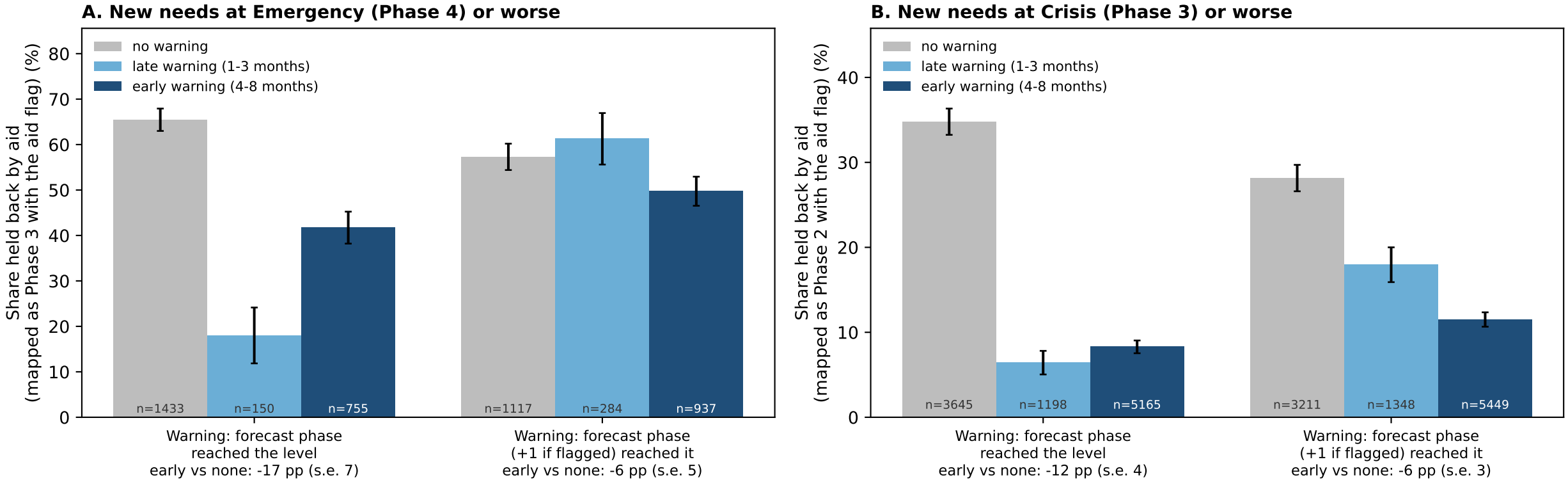
Taking FEWS NET's aid flag at face value: are crises it warned of early more often held back by aid?



FEWS NET current-situation maps 2011-2024. Need = mapped phase, plus one where FEWS NET flags that humanitarian assistance keeps the area at least one phase better. A new need is an area whose need reaches the level when its previous map (within 6 months) was below it; it is either realised (mapped at the level) or held back by aid (mapped one phase lower with the flag). Warnings: forecasts for the onset month issued 4-8 months (early) or only 1-3 months (late) before. Onsets with no forecast issued 4-8 months before are excluded. 95% intervals for raw shares; estimates in brackets compare onsets in the same country and map round, clustered by country.